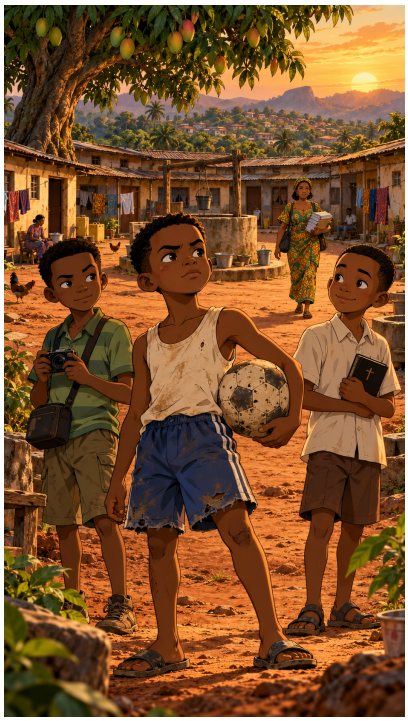
CHAPTER ONE · 5-MINUTE PILOT

THE COURTYARD KEEPS SCORE

Visual storyboard + timed shooting script



BOARD 01 · 0:00–0:08

COLD OPEN: THE BALL

CAMERA / ACTION

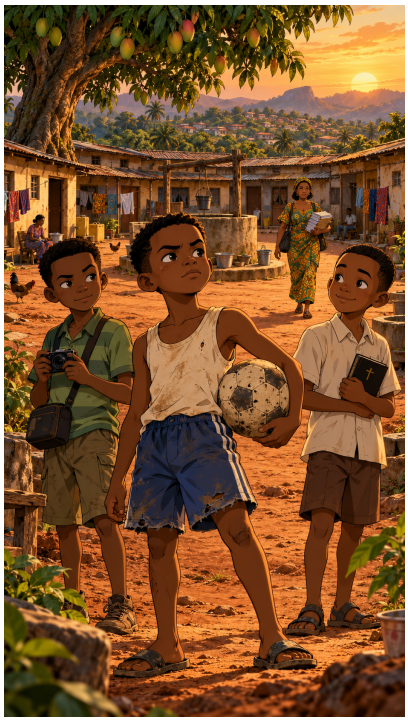
Macro on a spinning, scuffed football moving through red dust. Rack focus to two slippers marking a narrow goal.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Zino O.S. · ball thump, bucket rope, distant radio

CUT

Hard cut on impact.



BOARD 02 · 0:08–0:21

THE COMPOUND

CAMERA / ACTION

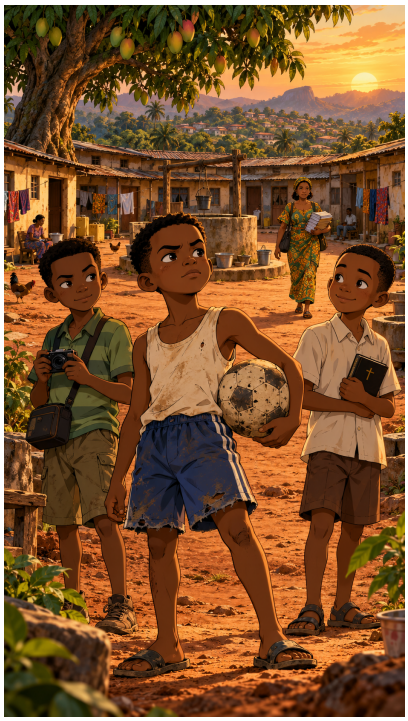
Tilt from mango leaves to Zino, Gideon and Luc. Keep the well and close-set homes legible behind them.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Gideon scores. Luc asks for fairness.

CUT

Whip pan with Zino’s run.



BOARD 03 · 0:21–0:40

THE MISS

CAMERA / ACTION

Low angle follows Zino’s shot. Hold a half beat as it brushes the outer slipper; reveal the plastic basin.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“Outside. No goal.”

CUT

Zino looks for listeners.

BOARD 04 · 0:40–0:58

THE FIRST LEGEND

CAMERA / ACTION

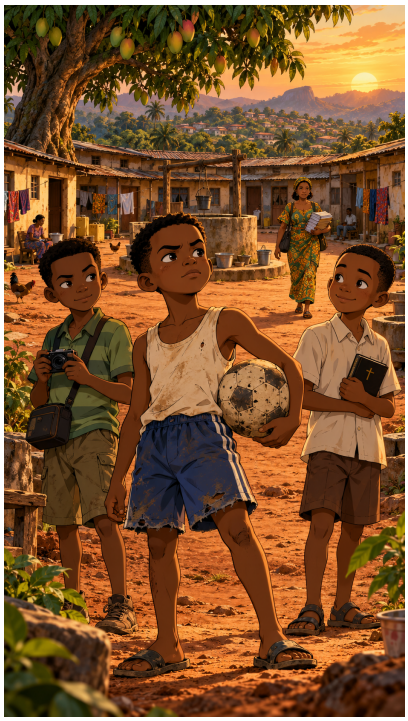
Match cut the ball’s arc into gold. Push toward Grand on the roofline; he bends the ball, but never flies.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Zino’s first impossible story.

CUT

Gold arc wipes into water ripple.



BOARD 05 · 0:58–1:18

BACK TO EARTH

CAMERA / ACTION

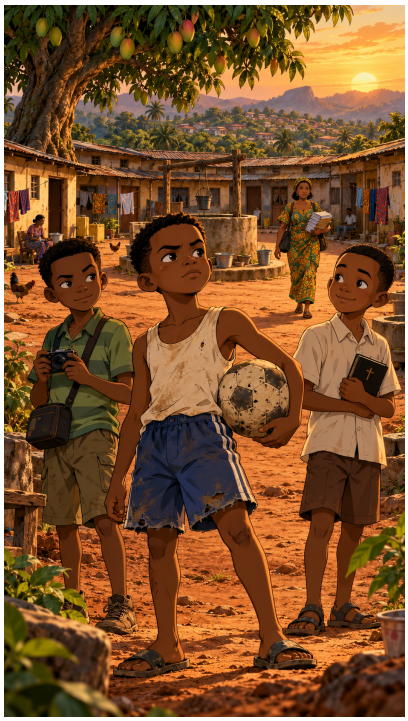
Real ball in basin. Reveal Mother, carrying marked exercise books. Her calm command changes the energy.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“Basin first. Football later.”

CUT

Cut on her pointed look.



BOARD 06 · 1:18–1:38

WELL WATER

CAMERA / ACTION

Side-on medium: Zino rushes the rope, gets splashed, tries again slowly. Gideon and Luc occupy separate thirds.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Friendly teasing; rope squeal.

CUT

Rope rises into notebook edge.

BOARD 07 · 1:38–1:58

THE PRICE IN THE COURTYARD

CAMERA / ACTION

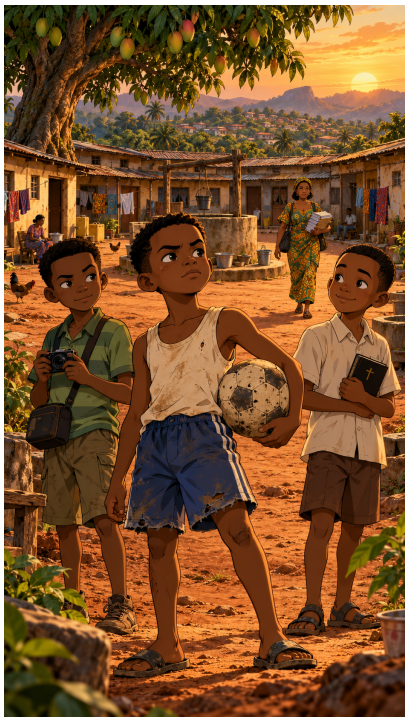
Long-lens, background action: landlord works door to door. Rack focus to Zino’s hand still on the well rope.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“Rent and light matter.” Keep amount unheard.

CUT

Notebook cover fills frame.



BOARD 08 · 1:58–2:16

A SMALL PLAN

CAMERA / ACTION

Mother puts a wrapped lunch and coins in Zino’s school bag. In the distance: bottles and a cloth of pooled stakes.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“Your head is not your stomach.”

CUT

Match cut coin to school desk.

BOARD 09 · 2:16–2:38

SCHOOL MORNING

CAMERA / ACTION

Wide lunch exodus, then isolate Zino as he folds coins into an exercise-book page. Gideon and Luc notice.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“Hunger no be strength.”

CUT

Bell tail becomes chalk scratch.

BOARD 10 · 2:38–3:00

THE ANSWER

CAMERA / ACTION

Push from the exercise book to Zino’s face as he answers correctly. Snap down to catch the falling folded paper.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Teacher: “Correct.”

CUT

Paper becomes white cloth under coins.

BOARD 11 · 3:00–3:18

THE OFFER

CAMERA / ACTION

Ground-level insert of bottles, slippers and small pooled coins. Rise to reveal the street circle around the boys.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

On-screen rule: hit opposing bottle three times.

CUT

Ball rolls at lens.

BOARD 12 · 3:18–3:37

FIRST HIT

CAMERA / ACTION

Slow anticipation, then normal speed when the ball clips the bottle. Track its fall to one raised finger.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Compact cheer; Gideon grins.

CUT

Cut on glass clink.

BOARD 13 · 3:37–3:58

THE TEST

CAMERA / ACTION

Reverse field geography as the opponent strikes Zino’s bottle. Move from coins into Zino’s changing expression.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Luc checks his temper.

CUT

Faint gold edge at bottle neck.

BOARD 14 · 3:58–4:16

THE SHOT HE CANNOT BUY

CAMERA / ACTION

Grand remains a faint outline and does not help. Zino misses; hold dust travelling past the standing bottle.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Mother calls from the compound.

CUT

Her call bridges us home.

BOARD 15 · 4:16–4:34

THE NOTE

CAMERA / ACTION

Low follow as Zino runs home. Mother waits in doorway with school notice and books; hide his coin fist.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“Come inside.”

CUT

Doorway shadow takes frame.

BOARD 16 · 4:34–4:48

THE QUESTION

CAMERA / ACTION

Over Zino’s shoulder. Keep the letter’s content unreadable. Push slowly toward his closed fist.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

“You know for what.”

CUT

Strip score to room tone.

BOARD 17 · 4:48–5:00

CLIFFHANGER

CAMERA / ACTION

Custom insert: Zino opens his hand. Coin shine becomes the fantasy’s gold ball arc; cut before the score.

SOUND / PERFORMANCE

Zino V.O.; distant radio; title card.

CUT

Black → Episode 02.